

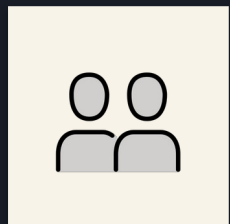
BRUSSELS · 16 JUNE 2026

TRIVIA NIGHT



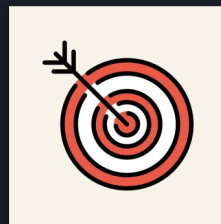
Permanent Representation of Lithuania to the European Union
Environment Team

HOW TONIGHT WORKS



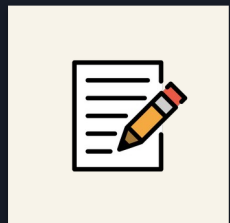
TEAMS

Draw a slip at the door — the river or lake on it is your team.



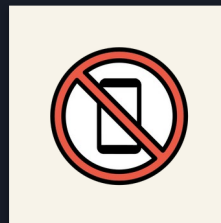
ROUNDS

Three rounds plus a bonus round. One point per question unless marked otherwise.



ANSWERS

Write your answers down — we reveal and score after each round.



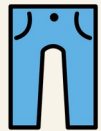
FAIR PLAY

No phones. Diplomatic immunity does not cover googling.

ROUND 1

EUROPE & FUN FACTS

Multiple choice · 6 questions · 1 point each



Which European island changes sovereignty every six months?

1

A Heligoland

B Pheasant Island

C Jersey

D Bornholm

B — Pheasant Island

DID YOU KNOW?

Under the 1659 Treaty of the Pyrenees, France and Spain share this tiny uninhabited island in the Bidasoa river. Administration alternates between the two countries every six months — the world's oldest condominium.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

Which EU symbol was publicly unveiled about 40 years ago?

2

A

Euro coins

B

European flag

C

European anthem

D

Schengen passport

B — The European flag

DID YOU KNOW?

In May 1986 the European flag was raised for the first time outside the Berlaymont building — twelve gold stars in a circle, a symbol of unity, unchanged ever since.



Photo: © European Communities, 1986

3

What major international award did the European Union receive in 2012?

A

Sakharov Prize

B

Nobel Peace Prize

C

Charlemagne Prize

D

Right Livelihood Award

B — The Nobel Peace Prize

DID YOU KNOW?

Awarded to the EU in 2012 for over six decades of advancing peace, reconciliation, democracy and human rights in Europe.



Photo: Reuters

Which euro banknote was nicknamed “Bin Laden”?

4

A

€50

B

€100

C

€200

D

€500

D — The €500 note

DID YOU KNOW?

The ECB stopped issuing the €500 note in 2019 over its popularity with money launderers — and because, like its namesake, everyone knew what it looked like but almost no one had ever seen one.



5

In 1984, former Nigerian minister Umaru Dikko was kidnapped in London. His captors planned to smuggle him out of the UK in a diplomatic crate, relying on the Vienna Convention rule that diplomatic bags cannot be opened or detained.

What went wrong?

A The crate was improperly labelled as diplomatic baggage

B Dikko did not fit inside the crate

C The aircraft meant to transport him never arrived

A — The crate was improperly labelled

► Watch the story

youtube.com/watch?v=N83ldy9IOmU

DID YOU KNOW?

With no official diplomatic markings, customs officers at Stansted were entitled to open the crate — and found Dikko unconscious, accompanied by an anaesthetist.



Press photo, Stansted 1984 — likely PA Images

6

One of the inventors of modern blue jeans was born in present-day Latvia. He developed a way to make work trousers much more durable and partnered with Levi Strauss to patent the idea.

What simple innovation made the trousers famous?

A

A zipper

B

Metal rivets

C

Waterproof fabric

D

Belt loops

B — Metal rivets

DID YOU KNOW?

Jacob Davis, a tailor born in Riga in 1831, reinforced the stress points of work trousers with copper rivets. He and Levi Strauss patented the idea in 1873 — and blue jeans were born.



ROUND 2

LITHUANIA

8 questions • 1 point each



Every year Lithuania plans to win Eurovision — although officially we never have.

In 2006, however, Lithuania tried a different strategy: entering a song that simply declared victory before the contest was even over.

What was the title of the song?

**eurovision
song contest**

► **Play the clip**

youtube.com/watch?v=DBAdOlQPbwg

“We Are The Winners”

DID YOU KNOW?

Honourable mention: Lithuanian-German singer Lena Valaitis took second place at Eurovision 1981 — proof that we keep looking for that victory by all possible means.



Photos: EBU / eurovision.tv

Two Lithuanian mountaineers carried a symbolic national object to the summit of Mount Everest and scattered it from the world's highest peak.

What was it?



Amber

DID YOU KNOW?

Vladas Vitkauskas (1995) and Saulius Vilius (2003) both carried Baltic amber to the top of the world and scattered it from the summit.



When Lithuanians learn about the interwar period, one statistic is proudly repeated in schools: in 1938, Lithuania ranked second in Europe in butter and bacon production — despite being one of the poorest countries on the continent.

Which country ranked first?



HINT *Think of a recent Council Presidency.*

Denmark

DID YOU KNOW?

A statistic still celebrated in Lithuanian classrooms. Denmark, for its part, no longer wants to be the EU's bacon factory — as Politico once put it.



Across Europe people celebrate Midsummer with bonfires.

In Lithuania, one tradition involves searching for a mythical flower that supposedly blooms only on that night.

Which flower?



The fern flower

DID YOU KNOW?

According to tradition, the fern blooms only on Midsummer night — whoever finds it gains happiness and wisdom. Botanists remain unconvinced.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

1918 was a big year for Lithuania — also for democracy.

Lithuanian women gained something that many women in Western Europe had to wait decades for.

What was it?



Voting rights

DID YOU KNOW?

Lithuanian women gained the vote on 2 November 1918, when the provisional constitution enshrined equal suffrage — ahead of much of Western Europe. A commemorative stamp marked the centenary.



A 16th-century Lithuanian nobleman travelled through Egypt and bought several unusual souvenirs.

During a storm at sea, terrified sailors blamed the bad weather on them and threw them overboard.

What were the souvenirs?



Egyptian mummies

DID YOU KNOW?

Mikalojus Kristupas Radvila the Orphan brought two mummies back from his pilgrimage. When storms battered the ship, the crew blamed the cargo — and overboard they went. His travel diary became a European bestseller.



In a humorous Lithuanian promotional video from the early 2000s, traditional dishes such as cepelinai are discussed with the idea that they might one day become popular across Europe as street food.

The video reflects a moment when Lithuania was preparing for a major change. What event was approaching?

► **Play the clip**

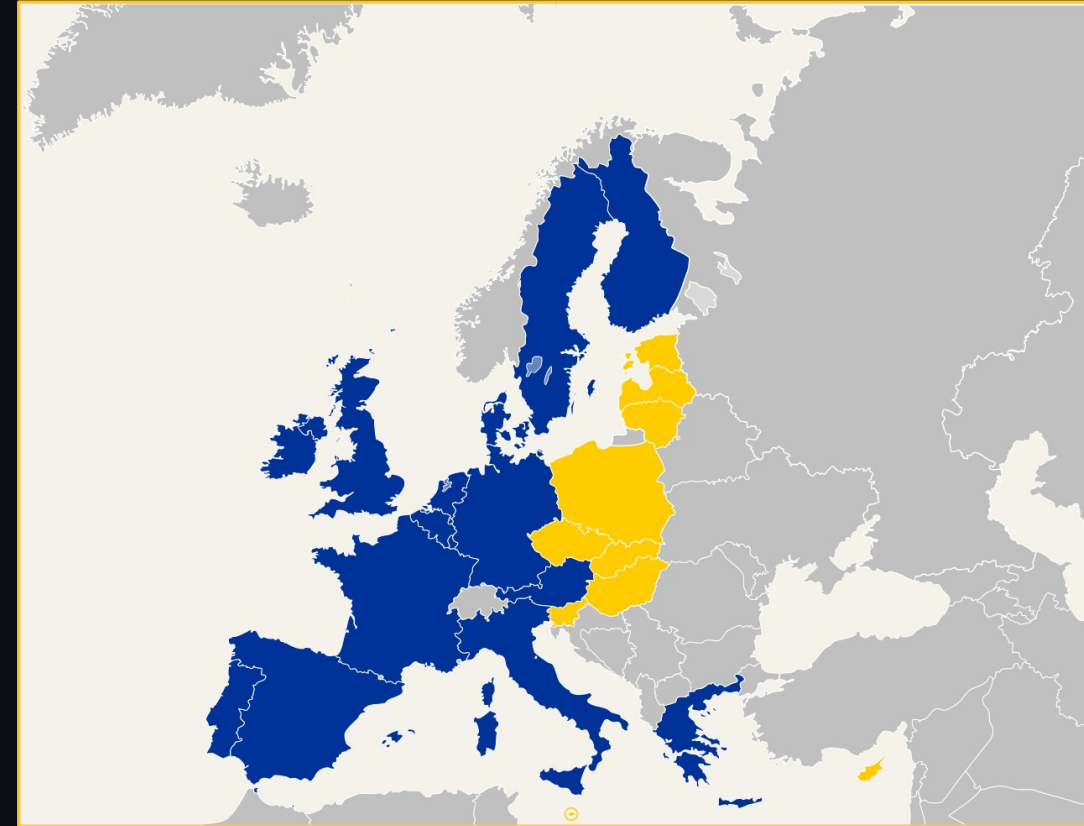
youtube.com/watch?v=YgvHcenDYcU



Joining the European Union

DID YOU KNOW?

Lithuania joined the EU on 1 May 2004, in the largest enlargement in the Union's history — ten countries at once. The cepelinai street-food revolution is still pending.



Map: Wikimedia Commons

Pink is strongly associated with Lithuania because of a traditional summer dish.

8

Which dish?

A

Cepelinai

B

Šakotis

C

Šaltibarščiai

D

Kibinai

C — Šaltibarščiai

DID YOU KNOW?

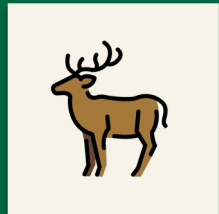
The electric-pink cold beet soup is Lithuania's unofficial summer flag — best served with hot potatoes and a sunny terrace.



ROUND 3

ENVIRONMENT & NATURE

4 questions • 1 point each



3

In 2013 Metallica became the first band to perform on all seven continents.

During their Antarctic concert, the audience used 120 of what?



Headphones

DID YOU KNOW?

To comply with Antarctic environmental rules, the band played without amplifiers — the audience of about 120 listened through headphones. The concert was fittingly called “Freeze 'Em All”.



Photo: Metallica (freezeemall.com)

Three famous scientists — Birutė Galdikas, Dian Fossey and Jane Goodall — devoted their careers to studying these animals in the wild.

Collectively, they became known as the “Trimates”.

What group of animals are these?



Great apes

DID YOU KNOW?

Goodall (chimpanzees), Fossey (gorillas) and Galdikas (orangutans) were recruited by Louis Leakey — hence also “Leakey's Angels”. Galdikas, of Lithuanian descent, still works in Borneo. “Orangutan” means “person of the forest”.



Collage: The New York Times

Which EU law unexpectedly entered the headlines after the deaths of four US soldiers, whose vehicle sank in a military training area near the Lithuanian–Belarusian border?



The Nature Restoration Law

DID YOU KNOW?

Commentary on the 2025 tragedy near Pabradė linked the swampy terrain to wetlands restored under EU environmental policy — putting the Nature Restoration Law unexpectedly in the news.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

This animal is often called an “ecosystem engineer” because it creates wetlands that benefit countless other species.

What animal is it?



The beaver

DID YOU KNOW?

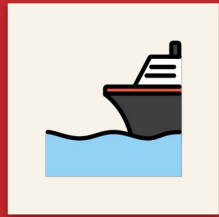
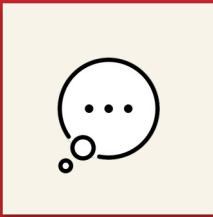
Beaver dams create wetlands that store water, filter pollution and host countless species. Lithuania's beaver population has grown from near extinction to one of the densest in Europe.



BONUS ROUND

THE BRUSSELS BUBBLE

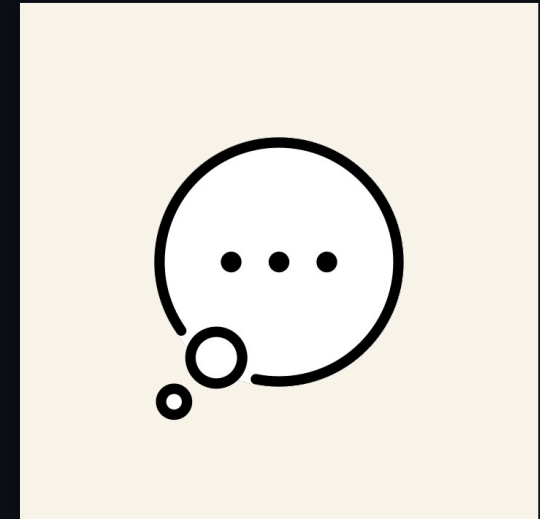
Insider questions · for those who were in the room





During negotiations on which file did Violeta Dragu (Romania) say:

“I have never seen Lithuania being so active during the negotiations”?



The Waste Framework Directive



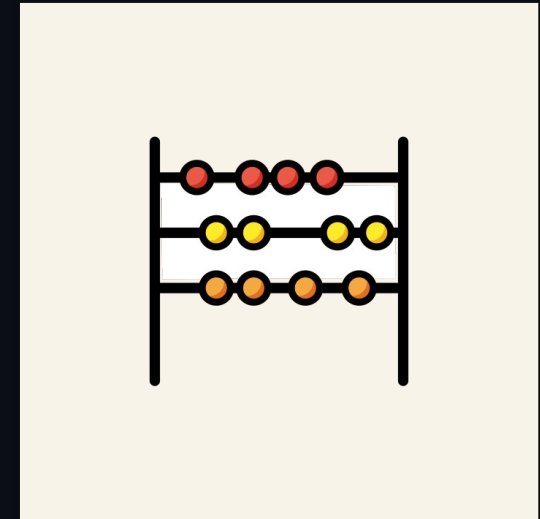
Illustration: EPRS briefing, European Parliament

2

During a Coreper I meeting, the Council was split on a legislative file, with both sides carefully counting votes.

The Deputy Permanent Representative of Lithuania intervened and said... what?

And which file was being discussed?



“Scrutiny reservation” — on the Nature Restoration Law

DID YOU KNOW?

A scrutiny reservation lets a member state hold its position while procedures are completed back home — a small phrase that can pause a finely balanced vote. Pictured: the Europa building, where Coreper meets.



1985: Lithuanian, Latvian and Estonian dissidents organised the Peace and Freedom Cruise aboard the ship Baltic Star — sailing from Stockholm along the edge of Soviet territorial waters and ending with a widely reported demonstration in Helsinki.

The Soviet Union tried to derail the voyage. What did it do?



A rumour that a bomb was on board

DID YOU KNOW?

The rumour failed: the cruise went ahead, and the Helsinki demonstration was reported across the Scandinavian and wider European press — a loud reminder that the Baltic states had not been forgotten.



Cartoon, 1985 — exile press, via X



THANK YOU FOR PLAYING

Time to count the points

